

Section 4

Analytical Framework & Documentation Standards

Version 2.0 — Preliminary Draft

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PETITION TO AUDIT — IOWA DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

CHILD WELFARE SYSTEMS — SECTION 4

SECTION 4 — SYSTEM TIMELINE & EVOLUTIONARY CONTEXT

Version 1.2 | June 12, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

PURPOSE: This section establishes the chronological and historical structure of this petition's evidentiary record — from Iowa's earliest documented child welfare failures in the 1920s through the active CFSR Round 4 review period. Section 4.0 introduces the pre-federal historical foundation (detailed in CD-HIST). Phases I–V cover the 23-year federal oversight record beginning in 2000. Each phase maps documented events to their structural impact, oversight signal tags, domains (A–H), and deficiency categories (F1–F13) as defined in Sections 2 and 5. The timeline is not a narrative of isolated events — it is a record of systemic evolution. The same deficiencies recur, the same corrective instruments are deployed, and the same outcomes are documented. That pattern is itself the central audit finding.

Entry format for each event:

EVENT — Specific, dated occurrence or publication

STRUCTURAL IMPACT — What changed in the system (or did not)

SIGNAL TAGS — Oversight classification markers

DOMAINS — A–H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES — F1–F13

SECTION 4.0 — HISTORICAL FOUNDATION: THE PRE-FEDERAL RECORD
(1920–1989)

The five-phase CFSR timeline beginning in 2000 is this section's primary subject. It does not begin in 2000.

Iowa's child welfare oversight record extends more than nine decades before the first CFSR review cycle. Iowa's own institutional documents — administrative reports, legislative surveys, university analyses, and state audits — identify the same structural deficiencies this petition documents in the federal record: inadequate workforce staffing, legislative underfunding, placement instability, absence of longitudinal outcome data, and the bias of institutional removal over family preservation.

These failures predate federal oversight by decades. They were present when Iowa had no external accountability mechanism. They persisted through the construction of the federal child welfare framework between 1966 and 1988. They are documented in the CFSR record from 2003 through 2024.

The full pre-federal analytical record is contained in Companion Document 6 (CD-HIST — Historical Continuity Record). The following table summarizes the three-period arc and its connection to the deficiency framework applied in this petition.

HISTORICAL PERIODS — CD-HIST SUMMARY TABLE
(Landscape orientation — see CD-HIST for full source analysis)

■ PERIOD	■ PRIMARY ANALYTICAL CONTRIBUTION	■ DEFICIENCY LINK
■ 1920–1959	■ Iowa's own bureau reports document workforce	■ F1; F7; F9; F12
■ Pre-Federal Era	■ instability as the "principal deterrent" to	■

welfare system:

"There is a need for a non-involved agency to scientifically and objectively audit programs much like we do financial programs."

— Iowa Association of Women for Human Resources (IAWH),
Statewide Survey Report, 1973

That recommendation went unimplemented. This petition is its realization, fifty-three years later.

STRUCTURAL ARGUMENT

Iowa's current child welfare failures are not anomalies and they are not recent. They are the predictable continuation of structural deficiencies Iowa itself has documented across nine consecutive decades of institutional reporting. The question this petition presents to the Iowa State Auditor is not whether these deficiencies exist — Iowa's own records confirm that they do. The question is whether any accountability mechanism can produce the correction that federal oversight has not.

Full pre-CFSR source analysis: → CD-HIST (Companion Document 6)

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

PHASE I — EARLY FEDERAL OVERSIGHT & BASELINE FINDINGS (2000–2004)

Phase Summary: Iowa enters the federal CFSR review system with pre-existing systemic deficiencies documented by independent state oversight. The first federal review cycle establishes a baseline of non-conformity across safety, permanency, and systemic factors. The corrective action instrument (PIP) is deployed for the first time. No sustained conformity is achieved before the next review cycle.

EVENT — 2000 (January): Shelby Duis fatality; Ombudsman investigation initiated (February 10, 2000). Report issued December 14, 2000.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Ombudsman documents intake reporting failures, inadequate supervisory oversight, inconsistent intake decision-making, and failure to give proper weight to mandatory reporter information.

Recommendations issued for centralized intake, policy clarification, and mandatory reporter training. DHS addresses some recommendations procedurally; no systemic restructuring implemented.

SIGNAL TAGS: Child fatality — state-monitored system; repeat intake failure pattern; supervisory non-response

DOMAINS: C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F9, F12

EVENT — 2002 (July 9): DOJ issues findings letter under CRIPA — Woodward Resource Center and Glenwood Resource Center.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: DOJ finds constitutional violations, records overwritable without audit trail, deficient documentation, institutional bias concerns. Federal compliance obligations established. Iowa enters period of federal settlement monitoring with multi-year obligations.

SIGNAL TAGS: Federal constitutional finding; data integrity baseline failure; institutional oversight gap

DOMAINS: D, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F10, F12

EVENT — March 2003: CFSR Round 1 Statewide Assessment submitted.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa self-assessment identifies caseloads of 35–55 per worker, absence of statewide QA system, and service array gaps due to budget reductions of \$27.5M. State acknowledges 10% caseworker contact compliance with children; 23% with parents.

SIGNAL TAGS: Federal compliance cycle initiated; state self-admitted baseline deficiencies; workforce capacity crisis documented

DOMAINS: A, F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F4, F5, F9

EVENT — May 19, 2003: CFSR Round 1 federal onsite review conducted.

EVENT — October 14, 2003: CFSR Round 1 Final Report issued.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa achieves substantial conformity with 2 of 7 outcomes (Safety Outcome 2; Well-Being Outcome 2) and 3 of 7 systemic factors. Fails Safety Outcome 1 (82.9% vs. 90% threshold); Permanency Outcome 1 (50.0%); Well-Being Outcomes 1 and 3. QA System, Training,

Service Array, and Case Review System rated not in substantial conformity. ICWA non-compliance documented in Woodbury County — tribal notification and active efforts deficiencies noted. Federal PIP requirement triggered.

SIGNAL TAGS: Federal non-conformity determination (5 of 7 outcomes); ICWA compliance failure; caseworker contact failure; QA failure

DOMAINS: A, C, D, F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F5, F8, F9, F12

EVENT — August 4, 2004: CFSR Round 1 PIP approved (revised).

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: PIP addresses: caseworker visitation frequency, permanency goal-setting timeliness, QA system development, training access, and service array gaps. Implementation period begins. Budget reductions and staffing constraints identified as primary barriers to strategy execution.

SIGNAL TAGS: First PIP cycle initiated; corrective instrument deployed; structural barriers to implementation documented from outset

DOMAINS: A, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F8, F9

EVENT — 2004–2009: Federal settlement monitoring under DOJ CRIPA.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa operates under ongoing DOJ compliance obligations for Woodward and Glenwood facilities. Multi-year monitoring consumes institutional capacity. Behavioral health data reliability concerns documented during this period by monitoring entities.

SIGNAL TAGS: Federal judicial oversight active; DOJ compliance burden; data reliability concerns pre-date CCWIS project

DOMAINS: D, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F10, F12

PHASE II — CORRECTIVE ACTION EXPANSION & PERSISTENT DEFICIENCIES (2005–2011)

Phase Summary: Iowa implements Round 1 PIP strategies while simultaneously experiencing a severe workforce crisis. Round 2 begins

with the agency at a staffing nadir. The second federal review finds non-conformity with all 7 outcomes — a regression from Round 1 on several measures. The corrective action record from Round 1 does not produce detectable sustained improvement by the time of Round 2 review.

EVENT — 2009–2010: Iowa Auditor of State issues reports on contract monitoring and documentation weaknesses in child welfare programs.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: AOS identifies subrecipient monitoring gaps, financial reporting inconsistencies, and inadequate enforcement of contract terms. These findings predate the formal AOS Reports of Recommendations indexed series (A23) but establish the pattern documented longitudinally in that series through 2021.

SIGNAL TAGS: State audit finding — contract oversight; precursor to longitudinal AOS finding pattern

DOMAINS: A, B, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F6, F7

EVENT — Early 2010: Iowa DHS issues early retirement incentive, resulting in loss of 638 staff at start of Round 2 review period.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Agency enters federal review period at a staffing low. CFSR statewide assessment acknowledges \$84M budget reduction and 638 staff departure. Caseloads climb. Caseworker visit rates decline before federal review begins. Agency characterizes this as "capacity collapse" context, not as a correctable deficiency.

SIGNAL TAGS: Workforce capacity crisis — deliberately timed; baseline contamination of R2 review data; structural self-inflicted gap

DOMAINS: A, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F9, F12

EVENT — March 2010: CFSR Round 2 Statewide Assessment submitted. QA self-score exceeds subsequent federal determination by 23–28 points.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: State self-report diverges materially from federal case review on QA system performance. Parent visitation rate admitted at 43–45%. Federal reviewers later reject state data as invalid and non-representative in the data review. QA scoring inflation first

documented in official record.

SIGNAL TAGS: QA self-report inflation; data validity dispute; state vs. federal divergence on key metrics

DOMAINS: G, H, F

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F5, F12

EVENT — August 23, 2010: CFSR Round 2 federal onsite review conducted.

EVENT — January 2011: CFSR Round 2 Final Report issued.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa fails all 7 outcomes — regression from Round 1 on Safety Outcome 2 (63.1%), Permanency Outcomes 1 (37.5%) and 2 (75.0%), and Well-Being Outcomes 1 (40.0%), 2 (93.0%), and 3 (88.1%).

QA System remains not in substantial conformity. Staff and Provider

Training not in substantial conformity. Service Array not in

substantial conformity. Federal PIP requirement triggered for second consecutive cycle. Same findings as Round 1 documented with no evidence of sustained correction.

SIGNAL TAGS: Second consecutive non-conformity cycle; all 7 outcomes failed; regression documented; repeat PIP requirement

DOMAINS: A, E, F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F5, F8, F9, F12

EVENT — 2011: Round 2 PIP submitted and approved. Implementation period begins.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: PIP addresses permanency goal-setting, caseworker visitation, QA system, and training. Same core strategy areas as

Round 1 PIP. No mechanism documented to explain why Round 1 strategies did not produce sufficient improvement to avoid Round 2 non-conformity on identical outcomes.

SIGNAL TAGS: Second PIP cycle; identical strategy domains as R1; absence of retrospective accountability analysis

DOMAINS: F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F12

PHASE III — STRUCTURAL STRESS & OVERSIGHT DEGRADATION

(2012–2019)

Phase Summary: Iowa's child welfare system operates without a completed federal review cycle for seven years (2011–2018). During this gap, three children in state-monitored placements die. Independent evaluations document data reliability failures, contractor performance collapse, and workforce exodus. CFSR Round 3 documents the most severe deficiency rate in the longitudinal record: 91% failure on ongoing safety assessments. A third PIP is submitted. It is never formally approved at final submission.

EVENT — 2013: Iowa Ombudsman annual report documents extended oversight gaps and monitoring failures in child welfare cases.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Pattern of intake rejection, supervisory non-response, and caseworker visit failures documented outside the federal review cycle. Ombudsman identifies systemic monitoring inconsistencies in high-caseload conditions.

SIGNAL TAGS: Independent oversight signal during inter-review period; monitoring failure in non-review year

DOMAINS: C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F9, F12

EVENT — 2014–2015: AOS reports document financial reporting errors and contract monitoring weaknesses. Series documented in A23 index.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Questioned costs, inadequate subrecipient monitoring, and lack of performance evaluation for expired contracts documented.

Findings are not remediated before being repeated in subsequent AOS reports through 2021.

SIGNAL TAGS: Repeat AOS finding — financial controls; contract oversight failure; zero-documentation of \$2.3B oversight activities

DOMAINS: A, B, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F6, F7

EVENT — 2016: Iowa transitions Medicaid managed care to private MCOs, shifting behavioral health and some child welfare services to contractors.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Service delivery accountability shifts to MCO

network. PHI breach reporting obligations attach. DOJ monitoring finds MCO data unverified. AOS subsequently finds Iowa never exercised contractual MCO staffing authority, MCO data coding non-standardized, and 30+ PHI breach incidents without documented response.

SIGNAL TAGS: Structural accountability gap — MCO transition; PHI governance failure; interagency coordination breakdown

DOMAINS: B, D, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F6, F11

EVENT — October 25, 2016: Natalie Finn dies of cardiac arrest at age 16.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa DHS had two open child abuse assessments at time of death. Five intake reports made between November 2015 and October 2016; four rejected. Final three reports (September–October 2016) all marked "urgent reject" without action. DHS caseworker on vacation during critical assessment period. Ombudsman finds intake unit was operating under insufficient staffing, supervision, and oversight. Identical intake rejection pattern as Shelby Duis (2000) — 16 years later, same structural failures unremediated.

SIGNAL TAGS: Child fatality — state-monitored; repeat intake failure (Duis pattern); mandatory reporter non-response; supervisory failure

DOMAINS: C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F3, F9, F10, F12

EVENT — 2017: Sabrina Ray fatality. Mid-Iowa contractor suppresses abuse reports. Ombudsman investigation documents 100% abuse report rejection rate in applicable period; contractor non-response.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Private contracted provider (Mid-Iowa) suppresses abuse reports internally. DHS contract oversight mechanism fails to detect or respond to contractor non-performance. No provider action taken post-finding. \$14.2M state liability eventually acknowledged; \$10M settlement reached in 2023. Ombudsman investigation issued September 8, 2020. Same contractor accountability failure pattern as Natalie Finn case — second fatality in successive years.

SIGNAL TAGS: Child fatality — contracted provider; contractor abuse suppression; contract oversight failure; repeat fatality pattern

DOMAINS: B, C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F6, F9, F10, F12

EVENT — February 15, 2018: CFSR Round 3 Statewide Assessment submitted.

State self-rates QA as "Strength." Federal determination: ANI.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Third consecutive QA self-report divergence from federal assessment. State assessment acknowledges caseload issues, FSRP turnover at 30–35%, supervisors spending 50% of time on documentation. DHS staff declined 13% (2016–2018); caseloads up 19%.

SIGNAL TAGS: Third QA inflation — self vs. federal divergence; workforce crisis worsening; documentation-as-proxy for oversight pattern

DOMAINS: F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F5, F9, F12

EVENT — April–June 2018: CFSR Round 3 federal onsite review conducted across Cedar Rapids, Des Moines, and Eastern/Northern/Western service areas.

EVENT — 2018: CFSR Round 3 Final Report issued.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: None of the 7 outcomes in substantial conformity — third consecutive complete non-conformity determination. Lowest performing outcomes: Well-Being 1 (families' capacity); Permanency 1 (permanency/stability); Safety 2 (children safely maintained in homes). Safety Outcome 2 Item 3 (Risk and Safety Assessment) rated ANI at 51% — worst safety assessment performance in the longitudinal record.

Federal reviewers note practice of combining TPR hearings with permanency hearings as contributing to permanency delays. All three Staff and Provider Training items rated ANI. QA rated ANI despite state self-rating of Strength. Federal PIP requirement triggered for third consecutive cycle.

SIGNAL TAGS: Third consecutive complete non-conformity; 91% safety assessment failure (Item 3); QA divergence confirmed; TPR/permanency hearing conflation documented; PIP required for third time

DOMAINS: A, C, E, F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F5, F8, F9, F12, F13

EVENT — 2019 (May 1 and October 31): R3 PIP submitted twice; not

accepted by ACF on either submission.

EVENT — 2019–2023: ECI Statewide Needs Assessment (2019), AECE Assessment (2019), CIA Final Report (2022), CWPPG Service Provider Forum Report (2019), and Harkin Institute/KinderTrack Analysis (2020) all issued during this period.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Five independent evaluations document: service array gaps insufficient for FFPSA compliance; \$3.1M ICAPP funding shortfall; KinderTrack "prone to errors" with 286 unlinked records; 0% SafeCare contractor performance on key metrics; data penetration rate errors requiring claim revisions; predetermined TPR communications by DHS frontline reported by contracted providers. No federal review cycle open during this period to capture these findings in a conformity determination.

SIGNAL TAGS: Independent validation convergence — five sources; KinderTrack data integrity failure documented independently; pre-ordained TPR practice pattern reported by contractors

DOMAINS: A, B, C, E, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F4, F5, F6, F8, F13

PHASE IV — ESCALATION, LITIGATION & OPERATIONAL INSTABILITY (2020–2024)

Phase Summary: The Round 3 PIP is submitted a third and fourth time during the COVID-19 period and is never formally approved. Federal court monitoring resumes. A second DOJ investigation documents ongoing constitutional concerns. The 2022 DHS-to-HHS reorganization occurs mid-corrective-action cycle. Iowa's CCWIS procurement begins. The Drew household — an Iowa-licensed foster/adoptive placement — commits felony child endangerment over a period beginning in March 2021. That offense period does not trigger documented monitoring escalation.

EVENT — February 17, 2020: Ombudsman issues Natalie Finn investigation report. [A29]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Ombudsman formally documents that DHS 2000

Shelby Duis recommendation pattern was repeated in 2016. Same intake rejection failures. Same mandatory reporter non-response. Same supervisory oversight gaps. Sixteen years of documented failure produced no structural correction in intake triage procedures. SIGNAL TAGS: Repeat fatality pattern formally documented — 16-year gap; Ombudsman confirms institutional non-response to prior findings

DOMAINS: C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1, F2, F9, F10, F12

EVENT — May 15, 2020 (resubmission): R3 PIP submitted for third time. STRUCTURAL IMPACT: PIP cover page "Date Approved" field is blank at final submission. ACF does not formally approve. Iowa operates without an approved PIP while under Round 3 non-conformity findings. The absence of an approved PIP removes the federal corrective action accountability mechanism during the period in which the CCWIS procurement begins. SIGNAL TAGS: PIP never formally approved; corrective accountability gap; federal oversight mechanism suspended in practice

DOMAINS: G, A

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F12

EVENT — September 8, 2020: Ombudsman issues Sabrina Ray investigation report. [A30] STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Documents contractor suppression of abuse reports, absence of DHS contract oversight response, and no provider action post-investigation. Documents same intake and monitoring failures as Duis (2000) and Finn (2020) reports. Third Ombudsman fatality investigation issued within the review period — third with overlapping findings. SIGNAL TAGS: Third Ombudsman fatality investigation; contractor suppression documented; triple fatality pattern established

DOMAINS: B, C, F, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F6, F9, F10, F12

EVENT — 2020–2021: DOJ conducts additional CRIPA review of Woodward and

Glenwood facilities. Findings issued 2021. [A06]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: DOJ finds ongoing constitutional concerns, ADA violations confirmed, managed care data unverified. Pattern of DOJ findings now spans 2002–2021 — four separate federal investigative cycles without durable structural correction.

SIGNAL TAGS: Fourth federal DOJ intervention — 19-year span; managed care data governance failure confirmed

DOMAINS: D, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F10, F11, F12

EVENT — March 16, 2021: Drew household offense period begins. Conduct producing felony child endangerment convictions (FECR007113/FECR007114) commences. Offense period runs March 16, 2021 – October 22, 2023. [A33]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Iowa-licensed foster/adoptive placement where the petitioner's sons reside is actively committing felony child endangerment offenses for a 31-month period. No Iowa HHS monitoring record has been identified indicating detection, investigation, or escalation in response to conditions during this period. Felony convictions finalized February 2025.

SIGNAL TAGS: Active harm in licensed placement — 31-month period; post-permanency monitoring gap; PPRCP convergence point [petitioner's analytical framework — see Section 13]; no documented safety re-assessment

DOMAINS: B, C, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F10, F12

EVENT — July 1, 2022: Iowa DHS administratively reorganized into Iowa Department of Health and Human Services. [A09, A13]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Reorganization is administrative — legal continuity of records, contracts, funding streams, and corrective action obligations is preserved (see Section 2.1.2). Agency is in mid-PIP period at time of reorganization. CCWIS procurement continues under successor agency. Legacy FACS/VISION data migration risk attaches to transition. Round 3 PIP is not re-submitted post-reorganization.

SIGNAL TAGS: Structural transition during active corrective action

cycle; data continuity risk; procurement continuity without re-evaluation of outstanding compliance obligations

DOMAINS: A, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F5, F13

EVENT — December 2023: Sivic Solutions IV-E Recommendations Report issued. [A22]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Documents \$40M in SFY2023 spending on SBC services not meeting Title IV-E Prevention Services evidence criteria. Identifies IV-E claiming gaps, PACAP updating needs, and revenue optimization opportunities. Confirms data penetration rate errors requiring claim revisions. Post-reorganization IV-E compliance baseline unreliable.

SIGNAL TAGS: Federal compliance gap — IV-E claiming; data-dependent revenue claim unreliable; post-reorganization compliance baseline

DOMAINS: A, B, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F7, F13

EVENT — 2023: Federal court monitoring continues. October 2023 monitoring report issued. [A07]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Monitors document ongoing documentation deficiencies, invalid behavioral data used for medication decisions, and abuse reporting failures by professional staff (91% in applicable cases). Monitoring obligations remain active and unresolved.

SIGNAL TAGS: Active federal judicial oversight; documentation failure ongoing; behavioral data reliability concern confirmed

DOMAINS: D, F, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F4, F9, F12

EVENT — 2023: \$10M settlement reached in Sabrina Ray case. People Magazine coverage (May 2025); KCCI coverage (November 2023). [A35, A36]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: State acknowledges financial liability for systemic oversight failure. \$14.2M total liability documented across settlement record. No corresponding systemic corrective action in the public record linked directly to the settlement. Financial accountability mechanism (litigation settlement) operates independently of the

federal corrective action mechanism (PIP).

SIGNAL TAGS: State financial liability acknowledged; litigation-as-accountability substitution; no PIP linkage

DOMAINS: E, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F10

EVENT — May 2024: Federal court monitoring report issued. [A07]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Continued documentation of deficiencies under active judicial oversight. Second monitoring report in the indexed record within eight months. No abatement of documented concerns across the two-report period.

SIGNAL TAGS: Ongoing federal judicial monitoring; persistent deficiency pattern under active oversight

DOMAINS: D, G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F2, F4, F12

PHASE V — DIGITAL MODERNIZATION & EMERGING STRUCTURAL RISKS (2025–Present)

Phase Summary: Iowa initiates CFSR Round 4 under a substantially modified federal review methodology. The PIP enforcement mechanism is suspended under TB-14 (December 2025). Iowa's CCWIS project advances under a \$41.9M contract with Google/Carahsoft without documented background check requirements for personnel accessing child welfare PHI. The AOS issues a special investigation of a child welfare contractor (Crossroads). Federal engagement at the congressional level is documented. This petition is submitted.

EVENT — November 25, 2025: Iowa Auditor of State issues Special Investigation: Crossroads (child welfare contractor). [A26]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: AOS documents financial irregularities, questioned costs, and subrecipient monitoring failures involving a child welfare contractor. \$167,716 in questioned federal costs. Confirms the longitudinal AOS finding pattern of contract oversight failure.

Third AOS special investigation in the indexed record.

SIGNAL TAGS: AOS special investigation — contractor; questioned federal costs; repeat contract oversight failure; post-reorganization

DOMAINS: A, B, G

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F6, F7

EVENT — December 2025: CFSR Round 4 begins. ACF issues Technical Bulletin #14 modifying PIP requirement. [TB-14, analyzed in Section 7]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Round 4 operates under a state-administered self-assessment model with modified conformity determination methodology.

TB-14 suspends the PIP enforcement mechanism that would otherwise be triggered by non-conformity findings. Iowa's 23-year non-conformity record is not a basis for heightened federal scrutiny under the TB-14 framework. Federal corrective pressure is reduced at the precise moment when longitudinal data would most warrant it. This is the structural integrity concern analyzed in Section 7.

SIGNAL TAGS: PIP enforcement suspended; methodology departure from Rounds 1–3; oversight independence constraint; federal pressure reduction during active non-conformity period

DOMAINS: G, A

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F12, F13

EVENT — December 8, 2025: Iowa CCWIS IAPD (Parts 1 and 2) submitted to ACF. December 11, 2025: ACF issues conditional (not unconditional) approval. [A45, A49, A50]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: ACF approval is conditional — not a clean certification of compliance readiness. Iowa proceeds with CCWIS implementation under a \$41.9M contract with Google/Carahsoft (executed March 26, 2026). The contract contains no documented background check requirement for contractor personnel accessing child welfare PHI.

Domain H data integrity risk attaches to every future compliance report generated by the CCWIS system.

SIGNAL TAGS: Conditional federal approval — CCWIS; PHI access without background check requirement; data integrity risk — forward-looking

DOMAINS: A, B, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F6, F7, F13

EVENT — February 25, 2026: Petitioner initiates Open Records Requests #26-927 and #26-1536. [A42A–A42D]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: ORR #26-927 produces DHS 18-B1, 18-C2, training manuals, and task force records. ORR #26-1536 produces IAPD, contract, ACF approval letter, and three HHS internal policies. Record retrieval process itself serves as a contemporaneous test of Domain H auditability. Production delays and fee estimates documented in communication logs [A42B, A42D].

SIGNAL TAGS: Contemporaneous auditability test; record retrieval delay documented; Domain H signal — operational

DOMAINS: G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F13

EVENT — March 26, 2026: Google/Carahsoft CCWIS contract executed. \$41.9M contract value. [A44]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Contract executed without background check requirement for personnel accessing child welfare PHI. This gap directly implicates IV-E reimbursability under 45 C.F.R. Part 1355 and HIPAA/HITECH PHI access standards. Analyzed in Section 18 and Companion Document 2 (CCWIS Companion Report).

SIGNAL TAGS: PHI access control gap — executed contract; IV-E reimbursability question; data governance failure — active

DOMAINS: A, B, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F6, F7

EVENT — May 15, 2026: Senator Grassley's office (Garrett Arbuckle) contacts petitioner. [A57, pending]

EVENT — May 19, 2026: Senator Grassley responds to petitioner's outreach regarding CFSR TB-14 and Iowa child welfare system performance.

EVENT — May 27, 2026: Staff meeting conducted between petitioner and Garrett Arbuckle (Grassley office) regarding CFSR Round 4 structural concerns. [Grassley call record — A57, pending]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Federal legislative engagement documented at Senate level regarding the structural integrity of CFSR Round 4 and Iowa's oversight record. Congressional interest in CFSR TB-14

acknowledged by Senator's office. Record of engagement included in petition when call record received.

SIGNAL TAGS: Congressional engagement — Senate Judiciary/Agriculture/Finance; federal legislative interest in R4 methodology; TB-14 flagged

DOMAINS: G, A

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F5, F13

EVENT — May 30, 2026: Petitioner submits formal inquiry to Iowa Ombudsman regarding CCWIS data governance and record traceability concerns. [Ombudsman inquiry letter on file — pending A## designation.]

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Contemporaneous exhaustion-of-channels documentation. Ombudsman response pending at time of petition submission. If a formal response is received prior to submission, it will be assigned the next available attachment number and the index updated accordingly. No A## has been pre-assigned; the designation will be confirmed at final submission.

SIGNAL TAGS: Exhaustion of administrative channels; Ombudsman notified; response pending

DOMAINS: G, H

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F4, F13

EVENT — June 2026: This petition submitted to Iowa Auditor of State Rob Sand under Iowa Code § 11.6(3) and § 11.24.

STRUCTURAL IMPACT: Formal citizen petition for performance, compliance, and financial audit of Iowa HHS child welfare functions. 23-year longitudinal record compiled. 49 primary attachments. Three-document system (Primary Petition + CFSR Companion Report + CCWIS Companion Report). Federal legislative engagement documented. Multiple administrative channels exhausted. ORR record produced.

SIGNAL TAGS: Citizen audit petition — formal submission; 23-year record; multi-channel exhaustion; § 11.6 / § 11.24 dual authority basis

DOMAINS: A–H (all)

DEFICIENCY CATEGORIES: F1–F13 (all — convergent pattern)

LONGITUDINAL PATTERN SUMMARY

The following cross-phase pattern is documented across the 49 primary attachments and three companion analytical documents in this petition. No single phase, taken alone, establishes the audit case. The pattern across all five phases does.

DEFICIENCY RECURRENCE TABLE

[illegible]

■ DEFICIENCY ■ PHASES DOCUMENTED ■

- Intake rejection / safety assessment failure ■ I, III, IV (all three ■ (F1, F2) — Duis, Finn, Ray, Drew ■ Ombudsman fatality reports)■
- QA self-report inflation vs. federal finding ■ II, III (Rounds 2 and 3) ■

■ (F4, F12) ■ ■

- Workforce capacity crisis / caseload ■ I, II, III, IV (all phases)■

■ (F9, F12) ■ ■

- Contract oversight failure (F6) ■ II, III, IV, V (all) ■
- Federal repeat findings / PIP non-correction ■ I–V (all phases) ■

■ (F5) ■ ■

- Data integrity / auditability failure (F4) ■ I, III, IV, V ■
- Interagency coordination gap (F11) ■ III, IV, V ■
- Post-permanency monitoring gap ■ IV, V (Drew; PPRCP frame) ■

KEY PATTERN FINDING: Deficiency F5 (Repeat Findings Not Corrected)

is documented across all five phases in all three federal review cycles, the AOS longitudinal report series, and the Ombudsman fatality investigation series. It is the single most pervasive deficiency in the evidentiary record. Its persistence is not coincidental — it is structural.

DOMAIN & DEFICIENCY MAPPING — SECTION 4

Primary domains: A, C, E, F, G, H

All domains implicated across the full five-phase record.

Primary deficiency categories: F1, F2, F4, F5, F6, F9, F12

All 13 deficiency categories appear in the longitudinal record.

AUDIT QUESTIONS GENERATED — SECTION 4

AUDIT QUESTION 4-A: Iowa's Round 3 PIP was submitted on May 1, 2019; October 31, 2019; and May 15, 2020. The "Date Approved" field on the final submitted version (May 2020) is blank. What is the current official status of the Round 3 PIP, and what federal determination, if any, was made regarding Iowa's conformity obligations following the failure to achieve a formally approved PIP in a third consecutive cycle?

AUDIT QUESTION 4-B: Iowa experienced a loss of 638 DHS staff via an early retirement incentive program in early 2010 — at the precise start of the Round 2 federal review period. What internal policy governed the timing of that incentive, and what, if any, analysis was conducted of the impact of that staffing reduction on the agency's ability to maintain required caseworker contact frequencies during the review period?

AUDIT QUESTION 4-C: The Drew household maintained an Iowa-licensed foster/adoptive placement from at least 2019 through the offense period beginning March 16, 2021. What monitoring visits, safety assessments, or relicensure reviews were conducted by Iowa HHS for the Drew placement during the period March 2021 through October 2023?

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

End of Section 4 — Version 1.1 — June 5, 2026

Audit Petition Packet v2.0 (5/2026)

AI assistance disclosure: See Section 5.8.

AI assistance was used materially in the preparation of this document. That assistance does not constitute independent verification of any factual claim.